

confidently. Sustainable growth, in our view, must be stress-free growth.

Refinancing of multilateral loans has emerged as a significant theme. How do you view IRFC's role vis-à-vis institutions like the World Bank?

Multilateral institutions play a critical role during the early, higher-risk phases of infrastructure development. Once projects stabilise, it makes economic sense for domestic institutions to step in. Refinancing allows multilateral agencies to recycle capital into new projects while reducing foreign-exchange exposure for Indian entities. IRFC's role here complements the multilateral system and strengthens domestic financial capacity — a key element of a whole-of-government approach to infrastructure financing.

Urban transport projects are expanding rapidly across India. Where does IRFC fit into this growth story?

Urban rail systems are essential public

infrastructure with significant economic and social returns. However, they are not purely commercial ventures. These projects require patient, long-term capital at reasonable cost. IRFC is well suited to support them because of our low borrowing costs and government-linked orientation. As projects mature and operations stabilise, we see meaningful opportunities to support metros and rapid rail through refinancing or structured lending, often alongside other public and multilateral institutions.

How does this expanded role impact IRFC's financial performance, particularly margins?

Traditional railway financing follows a stable, cost-plus framework. Diversified lending — even when government-backed — offers relatively higher margins. Our strategy is to balance stability with incremental improvement. As the share of diversified assets increases, overall margins improve in a measured and



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predictable manner. This ensures that shareholder value creation goes hand in hand with public purpose.

Looking ahead, how do you define success for IRFC in this next phase?

Success lies in consistency and credibility. IRFC must continue to support national infrastructure priorities, complement multilateral efforts, and strengthen domestic financing capability — all while maintaining zero stress on the balance sheet. If we can steadily improve margins, deliver predictable returns, and contribute meaningfully to nation-building through a coordinated, whole-of-government approach, we would have fulfilled our role responsibly.

